Provincial Mentoring

Provincial Grand Lodge of Hertfordshire

Prepare • Guide • Support • Enlighten

Mentoring the Entered Apprentice

First Degree · prompts for the Personal Mentor

Before, during and after his Initiation. Prompts, not a script. Explain the practical shape of the evening; never the ceremony itself.

1 PREPARE	■ Explain the timing, format and general structure of the evening, without giving away any ritual detail. ■ Make sure he knows the etiquette and dress code: punctuality, mobile phone off, cash for the raffle and charity. ■ Tell him he will be expected to say a few words at the Festive Board, and give him a short reply he can adapt. ■ Practical reassurance: everyone has done this; arrive early, relax, you will be guided at every step.
2 GUIDE	■ Introduce him to the Tyler, the Inner Guard and the Junior Deacon before the ceremony. ■ Explain that Initiation is the symbolic beginning of his Masonic journey. ■ Introduce the Masonic values of integrity, friendship, respect and service. ■ Set out what is expected: attendance, contribution, charity and the Festive Board. ■ Explain the social side and the importance of friendship, the Fleet House Light Blues Club, and signpost Solomon for further study. ■ Encourage him to visit another Lodge's Initiation.
3 SUPPORT	■ Explain the journey that follows the First Degree, so there are no surprises. ■ Questions are encouraged: you, the officers and the Brethren are available after the ceremony. ■ Introduce the Lodge Mentor and explain what a mentor does, and does not do. ■ Reassure him that the ceremony is symbolic, safe, and conducted with dignity and respect. ■ Begin to identify the questions that will lead him towards his Second Degree. ■ Explain what the Lodge of Instruction is and when it meets.
4 ENLIGHTEN	■ Introduce the moral themes of the First Degree: Faith, Hope, Charity, Temperance, Fortitude, Prudence and Justice. ■ Afterwards, encourage him to consider how the lessons of the First Degree apply to him personally. ■ Emphasise the wider role of Freemasonry in supporting communities. ■ Explain that there are three degrees, each building on the last, with opportunities for personal growth. ■ Introduce the Daily Advancement WhatsApp Group (DAWG), run by the Provincial Mentoring Team.

Companion to the Personal Mentor's Short Guide and the Stage Checklists · Never reveal ritual · Issue 1 (Draft for Review), October 2026 · © Provincial Grand Mentor, Province of Hertfordshire, 2026